

Sage, mushroom, buckwheat, and tempeh burgers

These extremely nutritious and uniquely flavored burgers actually look a lot like beef burgers—and, coincidentally, **taste great** topped with ketchup. Look for toasted buckwheat, which has more flavor than regular buckwheat, in your natural foods store and supermarkets.

6 to 8 dried shiitake or porcini mushrooms

¼ cup toasted buckwheat [40g]

1 tablespoon soy sauce

½ onion, minced

1 tablespoon olive oil

1 medium-large portobello mushroom, cut into cubes

3 garlic cloves, minced

2 teaspoons dried sage

¼ teaspoon crushed hot red pepper

4 ounces tempeh, shredded [125g]

½ teaspoon salt

¼ teaspoon freshly ground black pepper

¼ cup lemon juice [60ml]

3 tablespoons sunflower seeds

¼ cup shredded smoked Cheddar cheese [20g]*

Coarsely ground cornmeal or dried bread crumbs, for coating

½ cup canola or safflower oil, for frying [125ml]

1. **Soak** the dried shiitake or porcini mushrooms in 2 cups [500ml] hot water until soft, about 20 minutes. Lift out and squeeze excess liquid back into the bowl. If using shiitakes, remove and discard the stems. Coarsely chop the mushrooms. Strain and reserve the soaking water.
2. Meanwhile, **cook** the buckwheat in ¾ cup [150ml] water and the soy sauce for about 10 minutes, until just tender. Buckwheat cooks quickly, so keep an eye on it. Place the buckwheat in a large bowl and set aside.

*If you can't find smoked, use regular sharp Cheddar or a cheese of your choice.

3. In a large skillet, cook the onion in the olive oil over medium heat, stirring occasionally, until softened, about 3 minutes. **Add** the portobello mushroom, shiitake or porcini mushrooms, garlic, sage, and hot pepper. Continue to cook, stirring often, until the portobello is soft. Add the tempeh and season with the salt and pepper.
4. As soon as the ingredients in the pan start to stick slightly, **stir** in the lemon juice and 2 tablespoons of the reserved mushroom soaking water. Simmer for 1 to 2 minutes, or until the liquid is absorbed.
5. Remove from the heat and add to the buckwheat. Add the sunflower seeds and cheese and mix well. **Season** with additional salt and pepper to taste. Let cool, then form into 6 patties, about 3 inches [8cm] in diameter.
6. **Spread** out the cornmeal or bread crumbs on a plate. One at a time, place the burgers on the cornmeal or bread crumbs and use your hands to carefully coat both sides. Set aside on another plate or clean surface. Finish all 6 burgers and set aside.
7. In a large skillet, **heat** $\frac{1}{4}$ cup [60ml] of the canola oil over medium-high heat. When the oil begins to shimmer, add 3 burgers and fry until crispy outside and heated through, about 2 minutes on each side. Add the remaining oil and when it returns to temperature, cook the remaining burgers. Drain on paper towels and serve.

MAKES 6 BURGERS